



LANCELETS

Small marine chordates with slender bodies and a notochord throughout life, lancelets live half buried in the seabed. There are 20 species in the subphylum Cephalochordata.

REPTILES

With over 11,000 species, reptiles inhabit every continent on Earth, with the exception of Antarctica. Unlike birds and mammals, they are cold-blooded, and covered in scales.



FISH

Fish are the most diverse and numerous of all the vertebrate chordates. They are classified into a number of different classes, within the subphylum Vertebrata. These classes of fish are often grouped together as a superclass, Pisces, and their variety reflects their evolutionary past. Almost 34,000 living species are known.

BIRDS

Birds are the only living animals that have feathers. There are around 10,000 species of birds, though recent studies suggest there may be up to 18,000. All lay eggs, and many show highly developed parental care.



MAMMALS

Readily identified by their fur or hair (even whales have some), mammals are the only chordates that raise their young on milk. There are over 6,300 known mammal species.

